CONSONANT OR VOWEL Y?

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Y is the only letter in English that works as a consonant and as a vowel. At the beginning of a word it is a consonant: you can feel your tongue push the sound out in yes and yellow. Anywhere else it is doing a vowel job. Circle the job the y has in each word.

How to tell: cover the y and look at what is left. In **yes** you are left with "es", which already has a vowel, so the y must be the consonant. In **fly** you are left with "fl", which has no vowel at all, so the y has to be the vowel.

1.	yes	consonant	vowel	9.	year	consonant	vowel
2.	happy	consonant	vowel	10.	sky	consonant	vowel
3.	yard	consonant	vowel	11.	yawn	consonant	vowel
4.	fly	consonant	vowel	12.	puppy	consonant	vowel
5.	baby	consonant	vowel	13.	young	consonant	vowel
6.	you	consonant	vowel	14.	try	consonant	vowel
7.	cry	consonant	vowel	15.	yellow	consonant	vowel
8.	candy	consonant	vowel	16.	lucky	consonant	vowel

Count them: seven of these sixteen words use y as a consonant and nine use it as a vowel. Every consonant y in English sits at the start of a word or of a syllable, as in **can-yon** and **back-yard**.

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CONSONANT OR VOWEL Y? ANSWER KEY

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